Muhammad Rafay Waqar

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SUMMARY

Policy analyst with hands-on experience at the IMF and World Bank Group (achieved through participation of University of California Washington Program), specializing in macroeconomic research, stakeholder engagement, and data-driven policy analysis for MENA and South Asian constituencies. Published author of 12+ op-eds in national newspapers on political economy and international affairs. Multilingual communicator pursuing a career in geopolitical risk analysis, AI governance, and policy research.

EDUCATION

B.A. in Political Science | Minor in Technology Management — University of California, Davis *Class of 2026*

International Baccalaureate Diploma — Learning Alliance School, Lahore, Pakistan *2019 – 2021*

EXPERIENCE

(Visitor) Economic Analyst Intern — International Monetary Fund, Washington DC *08/2024 – 09/2024*

- Conducted macroeconomic and financial policy analysis for the OEDMD constituency (Algeria, Ghana, Iran, Libya, Morocco, Pakistan, Tunisia), producing impact assessment briefs to assist IMF Executive Board deliberations across 7 member countries
- Delivered quantitative research, stakeholder briefings, and policy recommendations to the Executive Director and Senior Advisor, synthesizing data from IMF surveillance reports and member country datasets

Policy Research Intern — The World Bank Group, Washington DC *07/2024 – 08/2024*

- Assisted the Executive Director's office by analyzing policy reports and drafting strategic content for work programs spanning 8 MENA countries; contributed to cross-functional stakeholder engagement across government and multilateral partners
- Produced country fact sheets and sectoral strategy input for MENA programs; conducted targeted research and data analysis for the Pakistan Country Strategy Framework 2024

International Student Representative — ASUCD, UC Davis, CA *05/2024 – 05/2025*

- Elected to represent 4,000+ international students; secured funding for multiple student organizations through structured advocacy and stakeholder negotiation with university administration
- Organized 10+ cross-cultural panels, workshops, and events; facilitated direct dialogue between students and administration to advance policy changes for the international student community

MENASA Resources Community Organizer — UC Davis, CA *10/2023 – 07/2024*

- Planned and executed 15+ community events (speaker series, cultural nights, workshops), averaging 50+ attendees per event; grew program reach by establishing 5+ organizational partnerships
- Built a digital outreach and strategic communications plan to strengthen MENASA community infrastructure across campus

Policy Intern — CoRe Alliance (Pakistan's first packaging recycling alliance), Washington DC *Summers 2023 & 2024*

- Prepared policy briefs on circular economy frameworks, EPR and emerging UN global plastic treaty; identified partnership opportunities across 10+ multilateral organizations
- Drafted a legal and regulatory roadmap for establishing the Alliance's first international office in Washington D.C.

Founder — Water4Pakistan, Lahore, Pakistan *2019 – 2022*

- Founded a multi-platform social media advocacy initiative on water conservation and pollution across Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter; crowdfunded $5,000 to fund clean drinking water access for school-going children in rural Punjab

SELECTED RESEARCH

MENASA Sovereign Risk Monitor — Live Analytical Platform *2026*

- Built a live sovereign-risk platform scoring 34 MENA, South Asia, and Horn of Africa economies on 11 World Bank macroeconomic and governance indicators
- Backtested against six historical crises since 2010; correctly flagged 4 of 6 in the same year they began, incl. Sri Lanka's 2022 default and Afghanistan's 2021 collapse

Gulf States Vision 2030 & AI Investment Tracker — Live Analytical Platform *2026*

- Built a comparative dashboard scoring 17 Gulf and regional economies on a Net Alignment Score, tracking US Integration Depth against China Exposure Depth
- Found AI governance maturity moderately-to-strongly correlated with a country's US export-control tier (Pearson r = 0.68) across all 17 tracked economies

SELECTED WRITING · OP-EDS & FEATURES

Published 12+ op-eds in The News International, The Express Tribune, and Dawn on political economy, international affairs, and social policy (2018–present).

- "The Last Barrel," *The News International*
- "Governing AI," *The News International*
- "Economic Agenda," *The News International*
- "Ukraine: Global Food Security," *The News International*
- "Genocides' Unseen Epidemics," *The Express Tribune*

SKILLS

Policy Analysis · Macroeconomic Research · Stakeholder Engagement · Report Writing · Data Analysis · Strategic Communications
Statistical Analysis (R) · Stata · Python · SQL · Tableau · Power BI

LANGUAGES

English, Urdu, Punjabi, Hindi (Native) — French, Persian (Basic)